- While run-off of nitrogen may cause harmful algal bloom, leached nitrogen compounds pollute ground water.

47. Temperate Deciduous Biome (Mediterranean Climate)
    - Trees with small broad leaves are widely spaced and never very tall.
    - Regions with adequate rainfall are inhabited by low, broad-leafed evergreen trees (mostly evergreen oaks).
    - Fire is an important hazardous factor in this ecosystem, and the adaptation of the plants enable them to regenerate quickly after being burnt.
    - Plants are in a continuous struggle against heat, dry air, excessive evaporation and prolonged droughts.
    - They are, in short, xerophytic (drought tolerant).

48.
    - A lagoon is a stretch of saltwater separated from the sea by a low sandbank or coral reef. Backwaters in Kerala are mostly lagoons where seawater flows inwards through a small inlet that is open towards the sea.
    - In estuaries, the water flows fast and strong, while in lagoons the water is shallower and flows sluggishly.
    - Estuaries are usually deeper than lagoons. Also, lagoons mostly do not have any fresh water source while the estuaries have at least one. Lagoons are more saline than estuaries.
    - Lagoons are formed due to falling in sea levels (coastline of emergence, e.g., Kerala Coast) whereas estuaries are mostly formed due to rise in sea levels (coastline of submergence, e.g., Konkan coast)

49. Smog is a combination of airborne particulate matter, like soot, and invisible toxic gases including ozone (03), carbon monoxide (CO), sulphur dioxide (S02), which are carcinogens (cancer causing agents). Sulphurous smog, also called as summer smog, results from a high concentration of SULFUR OXIDES in the air and is caused due to use of sul-phur-bearing fossil fuels, particularly coal.

50.
    - Bioremediation is limited to biodegradable compounds. Not all compounds are susceptible to rapid and complete degradation.